

Thick But Fit

Executive Summary

Client

Diana Byas

Student Consulting Team

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Mandi Niu

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Background

Thick But Fit is a women's fitness gym located in East McKeesport, Pittsburgh, serving primarily women aged 50 and above. Founded by Diana, our client, the gym's mission is to create a supportive community that helps women lose weight and build healthier lifestyles. It offers a range of programs, including group classes like line dancing and drum fit, as well as open gym access. Operations are currently managed through a mix of paper records and the GymDesk CRM, supporting member engagement and day-to-day management.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

During warmer months, Thick But Fit experienced a decline in attendance, with many members reducing visits or canceling memberships to prioritize outdoor activities, travel, and time with family and friends, resulting in seasonal revenue loss. This presented an opportunity to expand beyond the physical gym and reach customers who wanted more flexible, remote workout options. In response, the client developed a pilot online fitness challenge, and this project focused on scaling, promoting, and managing her challenge.

Project Vision

Our project ultimately aims to position the newly launched online challenge as a sustainable complement to in-person services at the gym. This is done through strengthening marketing and outreach efforts, and implementing more efficient systems for participant onboarding, engagement, and data tracking. Overall, our goal is to strengthen the gym's online presence and membership growth by establishing the new challenge as an additional reliable revenue stream.

Project Outcomes

This project establishes a set of integrated solutions that strengthen the gym's ability to operate, promote and scale its new online challenge program. The new challenge page on the website allows for a centralized source of information to enhance clarity and visibility for potential participants. A stronger marketing and publicity process for the challenge expands on the gym's existing online presence and leaves the gym owner with the knowledge to

continue effectively promoting the challenge. The owner will also have a new digital system to manage data for the challenges, providing operational insights that are easy to understand and use without technical knowledge. Finally, with structured challenge modules, participants and coaches will have a consistent and guided experience, with the opportunity to adapt additional challenges. Together, these outcomes leave the gym with stable technology and processes to manage and grow the online challenge.

Project Deliverables

The project delivers a complete, ready-to-use digital infrastructure that enables Thick But Fit Crew to efficiently run, track, and promote its wellness challenges. This includes structured Skool Course Modules that guide participants through the 21-day program, a fully integrated website challenge publicity page that communicates value and drives sign-ups, and a centralized Google Forms and Sheets data tracking system that replaces manual recordkeeping with automated, actionable insights. In addition, a comprehensive Business Marketing Plan equips the team with a sustainable, low-cost strategy for consistent outreach and engagement. Together, these deliverables provide a cohesive system that supports participant onboarding, progress tracking, marketing, and long-term program scalability, while remaining easy to manage using existing tools and minimal technical expertise.

Recommendations

The recommendations focus on maximizing the long-term impact and sustainability of the delivered system by strengthening operational consistency, marketing effectiveness, and future scalability. Immediate actions emphasize institutionalizing the three-form data tracking workflow, executing a consistent high-frequency Facebook marketing strategy, and leveraging Skool Course Modules as a self-service onboarding tool to improve retention and reduce manual effort. For future development, the primary opportunity lies in building an automated dashboard that transforms raw participant data into real-time insights, enabling faster decision-making and more personalized coaching.

Collectively, these recommendations position Thick But Fit Crew to increase engagement, improve retention, and drive revenue growth while maintaining a lean and manageable operational model.

About the Team

Samhitha Duggirala created the data tracking system and updated the new website page for the challenge. She is a third-year student majoring in Information Systems with minors in Information Security, Privacy, and Policy, as well as in Cybersecurity and International Conflict. She will be interning at Amazon this summer and is looking toward a career in cybersecurity.

Mandi Niu served as the Client Transition Responsibilities manager and updated the website and built and organized modules in Skool for the challenge. She is a third-year student majoring in Information Systems, and she will be enrolled in Heinz's AI Management Accelerated Master's program. She will intern at VIA technologies this summer as an embedded software engineer. She is looking forward to a career in AI management and excited to explore similar opportunities.

Arianna Martinelli supported communication between our team and client, and she worked on the strategic promotional plan while helping make updates to the Thick But Fit website. She is a third-year student majoring in Information Systems with concentrations in Product Management and AI Management. She will be interning at Cisco this summer and at a defense tech startup during the fall semester and is looking toward a career in AI product management.